JOEL BALUMA

Software Engineer | Full-Stack Web Developer (Laravel, React, Next.js, WordPress)

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ABOUT ME

Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience building and maintaining production web and SaaS applications. Strong full-stack background in React, Next.js, PHP, Laravel, and WordPress, including custom themes, plugins, APIs, and performance optimization. Experienced in improving existing systems, debugging legacy code, maintaining live systems, and delivering scalable, business-focused solutions.

SKILLS / TECH STACK

Frontend: React.js, Next.js, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Vue.js / Nuxt.js
Backend: PHP (OOP, MVC), Laravel, REST APIs
WordPress: Custom Themes & Plugins, CPT, Taxonomies, ACF, Performance Optimization, Elementor, BricksBuilder, BeaverBuilder
Database: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Tools: Git, Composer, NPM, SSH
Development Practices: AI code generation, scaffolding, refactoring, debugging, integration into React/Laravel/WordPress systems, and reverse-engineering autogenerated or unfamiliar codebases.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Developer - Freelance (Part-Time) | December 2025 - Present

- Designed and delivered custom WordPress themes and plugins aligned with client business requirements.
- Maintained and extended a Warehouse Management System (WMS) for inventory tracking, reporting, and operational accuracy.
- Provided ongoing maintenance, feature development, and performance optimization for client web applications.
- Leveraged AI-assisted development tools to accelerate feature delivery while maintaining full ownership of architecture, debugging, and production-ready code.

Software Engineer - Intetics | October 2024 - December 2025

- Developed and maintained production WordPress websites using custom themes and plugins, including internal tools for managing and tracking form submissions.
- Improved website performance through caching strategies, SEO fixes, and asset optimization, resulting in ~60% faster load times.
- Customized and optimized Unbounce landing pages with JavaScript enhancements to improve UX and conversion performance.

Software Developer - Freelance | July 2023 - October 2024

- Built web and mobile applications for healthcare and public sector clients.
- Developed clinic–patient online consultation platforms and internal management systems.
- Created a mobile application for a Government Rural Health Unit to collect and manage demographic data.

Full Stack Developer - Global OR Australia | June 2017 - July 2023

- Developed and maintained hospital operating room management systems using React.js, Next.js, and Laravel APIs.
- Implemented frontend interfaces and backend services supporting real-time clinical workflows.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver stable, production-ready healthcare applications.

EDUCATION

HOLY NAME UNIVERSITY
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology